

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

# compare-prose

Two prose options side-by-side with a labeled corner tag on each.

## Two options, equal weight, head-to-head.

### FIRST OPTION

Two-sentence description of the first option, including the strongest argument for it. Equal-density prose lets the audience compare line by line.



### SECOND OPTION

Two-sentence description of the second option, including the strongest argument for it. The `chosen` or `decision` modifier marks the verdict when one has been made.

## Same comparison, columns swapped.

### SECOND OPTION

Now rendered on the left. Pair with `chosen` to mark the swapped position as the verdict.



### FIRST OPTION

Now rendered on the right, second in the reading order. Useful when the natural argument flow wants the alternative considered before the lead.

## The right card is the verdict.

### BUILD IN-HOUSE

Full control of the schema and roadmap, but 2-3 engineer-quarters before feature parity. Maintenance burden stays internal.



### BUY + CONFIGURE

Ships in 6 weeks, not 9 months. Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features; exit risk is manageable via contractual data export.

# Build vs buy — decided.

## ~~BUILD IN-HOUSE~~

Full control of the schema and roadmap, but 2-3 engineer-quarters before feature parity. Maintenance burden stays internal.



DECISION

## BUY + CONFIGURE

Ships in 6 weeks, not 9 months. Engineering capacity redirects to product-layer features; exit risk is manageable via contractual data export.

## Long-body options stacked for room.

### BUILD IN-HOUSE

Full control over the schema and the roadmap, with 2-3 engineer-quarters before feature parity. Ongoing maintenance burden stays internal; the team owns every escalation, every migration, every breaking change. Worth it when the data model is the differentiation; expensive when it isn't.



### BUY + CONFIGURE

Ships in 6 weeks rather than 9 months, with engineering capacity redirecting to product-layer features the customer actually pays for. Exit risk is bounded by contractual data export; switching cost is a known number rather than a moving target. The right call when the data layer is plumbing rather than differentiation.

# Three reasons we are building.

BUILD

The platform is the product. Owning it owns the roadmap.



WHY NOT BUY

No vendor matches our compliance posture without surrender of control.

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## When NOT to reach for compare-prose.

**Code comparison.** Use `compare-code` for two fenced blocks. `compare-prose` is for sentences, not snippets.

**Three or more options.** `compare-prose` is strictly two. For three or more, use `cards-grid three` or `verdict-grid` with criteria badges.

**Verbatim text differences.** When the diff lives inside the prose itself — legal language, contract clauses — use `redline` so insertions and deletions render inline.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

- `before-after` — two states of one system, not two alternatives
- `compare-code` — the columns are code, not prose
- `split-compare` — the verdict needs a bottom recommendation bar
- `verdict-grid` — three or more options scored against shared criteria
- `decision` — the verdict slide that lands after a comparison